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Preparation of herbarium Specimen

Plant Collection
Plant specimen with flower or fruit is collected

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Documentation of field site data
Certain data are to be recorded at the time of plant collection. It includes date, time, country, state, city, specific locality information, latitude, longitude, elevation and land mark information. These data will be typed onto a herbarium label.

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Preparation of plant specimen
Plant specimen collected from the field is pressed immediately with the help of portable field plant press. plant specimen is transferred to a standard plant press (12" x 18") which between two outer 12" x 18" frames and secured by two straps.

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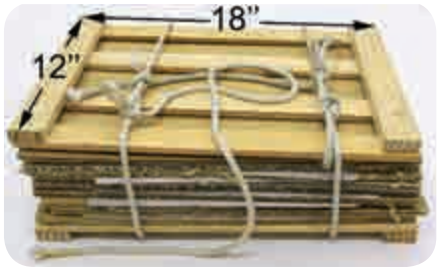
Mounting herbarium specimen
The standard size of herbarium sheet is used for mounting the specimen (29cm x 41cm). specimens are affixed to herbarium sheet with standard white glue or solution of Methyl cellulose.

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Herbarium label
Herbarium label size is generally 4-5" wide and 2-3"tall. A typical label contains all information like habit, habitat, vegetation type, land mark information, latitude, longitude, image document, collection number, date of collection and name of the collector.

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Protection of herbarium sheets against mold and insects
Applycation of 2% Mercuric chloride, Naphthalene, DDT, carbon disulphide. Fumigation using formaldehyde. Presently deep freezing(-**20°C**) method is followed throughout the world.









World's smallest water – lily *Nymphaea thermarum* was saved from extinction when it was grown from seed at Kew in 2009.

